



Union defense

Nashville was occupied by Union forces in 1862, and the city's defensive centerpiece was the star-shaped Fort Negley. Two years later, Nashville was among the most impressively fortified cities in the United States.

“ The **death-angel was there** to gather its last harvest. It was the **grand coronation** of death.”

PRIVATE SAM WATKINS, 1ST TENNESSEE INFANTRY, ON THE BATTLE OF FRANKLIN

Confederate losses

Daylight revealed a scene of appalling carnage. One man recalled how the dead were piled “one on the other all over the ground” and especially how numerous horses “had died game on the gory breastworks.” The Confederates buried 1,750 of their mangled comrades on the field that day. Around 3,800 wounded crowded the makeshift hospitals. Hood had lost nearly a third of his available infantry; some regiments counted upward of 64 percent casualties.